PILOT · FORECAST EDITION

NHS OUTLOOK

What the next monthly releases are expected to show

Across 8 headline measures, the next-release outlook is 2 improving, 3 broadly stable, 3 deteriorating. 6 of 8 measures remain off course against their medium-term milestones.

14 October 2026
8 indicators

Release months differ by measure; each row is dated.

INDICATOR	LATEST	FORECAST	ACTUAL AND INTERPRETATION
URGENT CARE			
A&E four-hour performance → 95% constitutional standard	**74.4%** Sep 2026 Known when forecast was made	**74.9%** Oct 2026 · Broadly stable 80% range 73.0%–76.7%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Category 2 ambulance response → 18-minute standard	**31.3 min** Sep 2026 Known when forecast was made	**33.7 min** Oct 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 27.9 min–38.9 min	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
PLANNED CARE			
RTT within 18 weeks → 92% constitutional standard	**65.2%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**65.1%** Sep 2026 · Broadly stable 80% range 63.9%–66.3%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Diagnostics waiting over six weeks → 1% operational standard	**24.7%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**23.7%** Sep 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 21.2%–25.6%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Cancer treatment within 62 days → 85% constitutional standard	**71.9%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**69.7%** Sep 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 68.0%–71.1%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
COMMUNITY			
Two-hour urgent community response → 70% national standard	**85.5%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**85.9%** Sep 2026 · Broadly stable 80% range 85.2%–86.6%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Community waiting list within 18 weeks → 80% by March 2029	**75.8%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**74.9%** Sep 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 73.8%–75.9%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
MENTAL HEALTH			
Talking Therapies within six weeks → 75% national standard	**83.4%** Aug 2026 Known when forecast was made	**84.1%** Sep 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 82.3%–85.6%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition

How to read this. Outlooks are one-month-ahead forecasts made only with information available before release. The 80% range reflects historic one-step forecast errors. Provider signals compare actual performance with a path fixed six months earlier; they are prompts for review, not rankings.

Sources. NHS England A&E attendances and emergency admissions · NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators · NHS England referral to treatment waiting times · NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity · NHS England cancer waiting times · NHS England two-hour urgent community response · NHS England community health services waiting lists · NHS Talking Therapies monthly statistics. Planning milestones and standards are cited in each indicator deep dive.